

Titanium Dioxide

China May Exports Still Higher Y/Y

- **China exported 152.8kt of TiO₂ in May, or 13% more tons versus 135.6kt last year.** Notably, China's exports of chloride-based TiO₂ were higher by 39% compared to last year, year to date. Sulfate-based shipments in May were higher by 7% y/y at 118.4kt versus 110.7kt, though lower sequentially. Net exports in 2026 YTD were 857.2kt, or higher by 107kt or ~14% y/y.
- **Exports to EU-27 were 17.5kt in May compared to 20.3kt in April and 15.5kt in May of 2025; YTD exports to EU-27 are higher by 29% at 97kt vs 75kt in the same period last year.** Exports to the EU totaled 169kt in 2025, accounting for about 9% of Chinese TiO₂ exports. Exports to India rose from 126kt to 166kt year to date or by 32%.
- **The May average export price of \$2,218/t was 8.8% higher sequentially and 7.0% y/y.** The average export price per ton in April 2026 was \$2,038/t, and prices averaged \$2,072/t in May of last year. Import prices were (8.3%) lower sequentially at \$2,958/t vs. \$3,225/t in April and (11.1%) lower versus \$3,329/t in the prior-year period. Please see Table 9 for more details.

Chemicals: Specialty, Commodity, Agricultural, and Paper & Packaging

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Table 1: China Total TiO₂ Export Data (in kt)

Exports	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026
January	48.2	52.0	59.3	69.1	69.9	102.9	106.7	141.4	131.6	159.7	158.5	183.8
February	42.1	44.7	52.1	70.1	64.6	71.2	94.4	101.4	154.2	133.6	157.5	151.5
March	46.9	61.0	68.7	103.6	98.1	157.1	126.9	145.0	151.3	196.0	185.0	201.5
April	43.6	55.7	64.8	87.0	77.0	88.1	107.2	118.6	128.9	157.4	148.0	193.5
May	47.3	71.2	72.8	79.9	88.5	66.5	104.8	115.7	144.8	149.3	135.6	152.8
June	44.2	63.9	78.5	83.0	83.6	77.3	100.5	124.4	125.6	176.4	131.9	
July	46.5	63.6	68.8	70.2	88.6	97.5	87.5	125.8	135.9	159.6	134.7	
August	38.4	65.4	71.2	75.7	87.3	117.1	102.6	104.1	137.5	160.7	138.7	
September	40.4	63.1	62.4	74.0	83.8	111.8	108.0	96.3	145.0	146.8	156.3	
October	45.5	54.6	67.6	63.0	79.4	110.2	115.8	99.1	118.8	154.3	146.4	
November	39.7	63.2	76.3	70.0	81.9	112.3	123.6	107.2	124.9	149.3	152.2	
December	55.6	62.0	88.1	62.4	100.7	102.0	133.7	127.0	143.3	158.4	171.8	
Total YTD	538.4	720.5	830.9	908.0	1003.4	1214.1	1311.6	1405.9	1641.8	1901.5	1816.9	883.1
% change	(3%)	34%	15%	9%	11%	21%	8%	7%	17%	16%	(4%)	13%

Source: China General Administration of Customs.

Note: Data in the table do not precisely match calculations due to rounding.

Table 2: China Total TiO₂ Import Data (in kt)

Imports	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026
January	13.7	13.5	17.9	20.1	12.4	7.5	15.9	12.0	3.6	6.6	7.3	6.1
February	13.4	13.0	18.6	8.6	8.4	17.7	14.5	12.0	4.8	7.2	5.2	3.5
March	14.3	13.7	17.6	17.0	11.6	12.2	16.2	12.9	4.7	10.5	8.3	5.9
April	20.3	13.1	18.7	19.1	13.2	12.3	18.7	15.4	5.5	6.8	6.5	5.1
May	19.4	15.9	20.4	18.3	13.7	14.0	15.8	15.0	6.4	9.2	7.5	5.3
June	18.3	19.3	21.3	17.6	15.9	13.9	16.3	12.7	7.1	7.5	4.9	
July	22.1	19.9	17.9	17.4	15.1	14.6	17.5	11.1	8.0	9.1	7.3	
August	19.0	13.2	17.0	15.9	15.2	12.3	15.1	12.4	9.2	6.4	3.4	
September	21.1	14.8	15.6	15.9	11.2	14.6	17.0	3.9	6.8	8.3	6.4	
October	12.7	13.0	18.7	16.5	18.2	16.6	12.2	3.3	7.8	6.4	5.6	
November	16.0	18.5	16.6	18.2	14.8	16.1	17.0	5.7	9.3	6.7	5.3	
December	13.5	21.3	14.6	12.8	17.1	16.5	15.8	6.9	11.2	7.3	6.7	
Total YTD	203.7	189.3	215.0	197.5	166.9	168.2	191.9	123.1	84.5	92.0	74.5	25.9
% change	(6%)	(7%)	14%	(8%)	(16%)	1%	14%	(36%)	(31%)	9%	(19%)	(26%)

Source: China General Administration of Customs.

Note: Data in the table do not precisely match calculations due to rounding.

Table 3: China Total TiO2 Annual Trade Data (in kt)

	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026
Net exports/(imports)	337	334.8	531.2	615.9	710.5	836.5	1045.8	1119.7	1282.8	1557.3	1809.5	1742.4	857.2
Net change	127	(2.1)	196.4	84.7	94.6	126.0	209.3	73.9	163.1	274.5	252.2	(67.1)	107.4
% change	60.2%	(0.6%)	58.7%	16.0%	15.4%	17.7%	25.0%	7.1%	14.6%	21.4%	16.2%	(3.7%)	14.3%

Source: China General Administration of Customs.

Table 4: China TiO2 Exports by Destination 2026 vs 2025

'000s of tons

2026TD		
Export Destination	Volume (in kt)	% of total
India	166	19%
EU-27	97	11%
Turkey	58	7%
Indonesia	50	6%
Vietnam	48	5%
Republic of Korea	46	5%
Malaysia	32	4%
Thailand	31	4%
Russia	28	3%
United Arab Emirates	25	3%
Other	302	34%
Total	883	

2025TD		
Export Destination	Volume (in kt)	% of total
India	126	14%
EU-27	75	9%
Turkey	54	6%
Republic of Korea	41	5%
Vietnam	35	4%
Brazil	35	4%
Indonesia	35	4%
United Arab Emirates	33	4%
Thailand	29	3%
Egypt	27	3%
Other	294	33%
Total	785	

Source: China General Administration of Customs.

Table 5: China TiO2 Exports by Destination 2025 vs 2024

'000s of tons

2025		
Export Destination	Volume (in kt)	% of total
India	257	14%
EU-27	169	9%
Turkey	120	7%
Vietnam	103	6%
S.Korea	93	5%
Indonesia	83	5%
UAE	74	4%
Brazil	70	4%
Thailand	64	4%
Egypt	62	3%
Other	721	40%
Total	1,817	

2024		
Export Destination	Volume (in kt)	% of total
India	308	16%
EU-27	244	13%
Brazil	137	7%
S.Korea	97	5%
Turkey	97	5%
Vietnam	93	5%
Indonesia	81	4%
UAE	77	4%
Russia	75	4%
Belgium	61	3%
Other	327	22%
Total	1,902	

Source: China General Administration of Customs.

Table 6: China Chloride TiO2 Export/Import Data (in kt)

Exports	2024	2025	2026
January	27.1	28.7	45.4
February	26.9	29.8	39.4
March	44.7	39.1	51.0
April	32.2	30.4	42.8
May	23.0	24.9	34.4
June	29.5	24.4	
July	25.5	24.5	
August	26.4	25.0	
September	27.0	28.8	
October	26.5	32.3	
November	29.9	34.5	
December	27.7	44.2	
Total YTD	346.4	366.5	212.9
% change		6%	39%

Imports	2024	2025	2026
January	4.5	4.6	4.1
February	5.9	2.7	2.3
March	8.1	4.6	3.8
April	3.8	3.8	2.6
May	6.9	4.2	2.8
June	4.6	3.5	
July	6.0	5.3	
August	3.8	1.9	
September	4.6	3.5	
October	4.4	2.8	
November	3.7	3.8	
December	4.2	3.5	
Total YTD	60.5	44.3	15.6
% change		(27%)	(22%)

Note: Data in the table do not precisely match calculations due to rounding.
Source: China General Administration of Customs.

Table 7: China Sulfate TiO2 Export/Import Data (in kt)

Exports	2024	2025	2026
January	133.2	129.8	138.4
February	106.7	127.7	112.1
March	151.4	145.9	150.6
April	125.2	117.6	150.7
May	126.3	110.7	118.4
June	146.9	107.5	
July	134.2	110.2	
August	134.2	113.7	
September	119.7	127.6	
October	127.8	114.2	
November	119.3	117.7	
December	130.7	127.7	
Total YTD	1555.7	1450.3	670.1
% change		(7%)	6%

Imports	2024	2025	2026
January	2.1	2.7	2.0
February	1.3	2.5	1.2
March	2.4	3.7	2.2
April	3.0	2.7	2.5
May	2.3	3.2	2.4
June	3.0	1.4	
July	3.1	2.0	
August	2.6	1.6	
September	3.7	2.9	
October	2.0	2.8	
November	3.0	1.5	
December	3.0	3.1	
Total YTD	31.5	30.2	10.3
% change		(4%)	(30%)

Note: Data in the table do not precisely match calculations due to rounding.
Source: China General Administration of Customs.

Table 8: Chinese Monthly Total TiO2 Exports to EU-27

	Volume (in kt)	Price (\$/ton)
Jan-24	32.3	2,099
Feb-24	28.7	2,123
Mar-24	32.1	2,215
Apr-24	33.6	2,242
May-24	24.3	2,250
Jun-24	16.8	2,216
Jul-24	7.5	2,160
Aug-24	18.5	2,132
Sep-24	11.0	2,221
Oct-24	16.8	2,206
Nov-24	10.5	2,107
Dec-24	11.6	2,102
Jan-25	12.4	2,050
Feb-25	14.5	2,051
Mar-25	16.8	2,080
Apr-25	16.2	2,133
May-25	15.5	2,186
Jun-25	16.2	2,165
Jul-25	11.2	2,121
Aug-25	10.7	2,024
Sep-25	10.6	1,952
Oct-25	15.5	1,952
Nov-25	13.6	1,943
Dec-25	16.3	1,934
Jan-26	16.4	1,945
Feb-26	18.9	1,999
Mar-26	23.9	2,094
Apr-26	20.3	2,272
May-26	17.5	2,431

Source: China General Administration of Customs, J.P. Morgan estimates

Table 9: Chinese Total TiO2 Export/Import Prices

	import price \$/mt	Sq. % change	Y/y % change	export price \$/mt	Sq. % change	Y/y % change
Feb-20	2,873	-1.4%	-6.7%	2,037	0.0%	-9.4%
Mar-20	2,914	0.0%	-1.3%	2,047	0.5%	-9.7%
Apr-20	2,926	0.4%	-3.0%	2,060	0.6%	-10.0%
May-20	2,817	-3.7%	-4.1%	2,031	-1.4%	-11.2%
Jun-20	2,847	1.0%	-6.0%	1,919	-5.5%	-15.3%
Jul-20	2,918	2.5%	-2.7%	1,821	-5.1%	-17.1%
Aug-20	2,887	-1.0%	-5.1%	1,787	-1.9%	-17.0%
Sep-20	2,745	-4.9%	-11.8%	1,785	-0.1%	-16.0%
Oct-20	2,701	-1.6%	-6.9%	1,817	1.8%	-14.2%
Nov-20	2,808	3.9%	-3.7%	1,911	5.2%	-9.1%
Dec-20	2,856	1.7%	0.2%	2,019	5.6%	-2.8%
Jan-21	2,838	-0.6%	-2.6%	2,200	9.0%	8.0%
Feb-21	2,881	1.5%	0.3%	2,357	7.1%	15.7%
Mar-21	2,978	3.4%	2.2%	2,521	6.9%	23.1%
Apr-21	2,956	-0.7%	1.0%	2,697	7.0%	30.9%
May-21	2,996	1.4%	6.3%	2,821	4.6%	38.9%
Jun-21	2,994	-0.1%	5.2%	2,932	3.9%	52.8%
Jul-21	3,007	0.4%	3.1%	2,966	1.2%	62.9%
Aug-21	3,195	6.2%	10.6%	2,937	-1.0%	64.4%
Sep-21	3,178	-0.5%	15.8%	2,881	-1.9%	61.4%
Oct-21	3,269	2.9%	21.0%	2,918	1.3%	60.6%
Nov-21	3,270	0.1%	16.5%	2,985	2.3%	56.2%
Dec-21	3,351	2.4%	17.3%	3,023	1.3%	49.7%
Jan-22	3,326	-0.7%	17.2%	3,000	-0.8%	36.3%
Feb-22	3,328	0.1%	15.5%	3,006	0.2%	27.5%
Mar-22	3,472	4.3%	16.6%	3,034	0.9%	20.4%
Apr-22	3,452	-0.6%	16.8%	3,051	0.6%	13.1%
May-22	3,698	7.1%	23.4%	3,045	-0.2%	7.9%
Jun-22	3,878	4.9%	29.5%	2,994	-1.6%	2.1%
Jul-22	3,800	-2.0%	26.4%	2,875	-4.0%	-3.1%
Aug-22	3,744	-1.5%	17.2%	2,667	-7.2%	-9.2%
Sep-22	3,956	5.6%	24.5%	2,403	-9.9%	-16.6%
Oct-22	4,001	1.1%	22.4%	2,212	-8.0%	-24.2%
Nov-22	3,653	-8.7%	11.7%	2,091	-5.5%	-29.9%
Dec-22	3,578	-2.1%	6.8%	2,080	-0.6%	-31.2%
Jan-23	3,903	9.1%	17.4%	2,098	0.9%	-30.1%
Feb-23	3,578	-8.3%	7.5%	2,120	1.1%	-29.5%
Mar-23	3,742	4.6%	7.8%	2,197	3.6%	-27.6%
Apr-23	3,621	-3.2%	4.9%	2,244	2.1%	-26.5%
May-23	3,508	-3.1%	-5.1%	2,272	1.3%	-25.4%
Jun-23	3,410	-2.8%	-12.1%	2,252	-0.9%	-24.8%
Jul-23	3,466	1.6%	-8.8%	2,165	-3.9%	-24.7%
Aug-23	3,235	-6.7%	-13.6%	2,131	-1.5%	-20.1%
Sep-23	3,393	4.9%	-14.2%	2,169	1.8%	-9.8%
Oct-23	3,297	-2.8%	-17.6%	2,211	2.0%	0.0%
Nov-23	3,094	-6.2%	-15.3%	2,229	0.8%	6.6%
Dec-23	3,074	-0.7%	-14.1%	2,222	-0.3%	6.8%
Jan-24	3,288	7.0%	-15.8%	2,184	-1.7%	4.1%
Feb-24	3,037	-7.6%	-15.1%	2,201	0.8%	3.8%
Mar-24	3,198	5.3%	-14.5%	2,265	2.9%	3.1%
Apr-24	3,463	8.3%	-4.3%	2,299	1.5%	2.5%
May-24	3,239	-6.5%	-7.7%	2,297	-0.1%	1.1%
Jun-24	3,212	-0.8%	-5.8%	2,235	-2.7%	-0.7%
Jul-24	3,280	2.1%	-5.4%	2,175	-2.7%	0.5%
Aug-24	3,568	8.8%	10.3%	2,161	-0.6%	1.4%
Sep-24	3,475	-2.6%	2.4%	2,178	0.8%	0.4%
Oct-24	3,458	-0.5%	4.9%	2,167	-0.5%	-2.0%
Nov-24	3,622	4.7%	17.1%	2,125	-1.9%	-4.7%
Dec-24	3,519	-2.9%	14.5%	2,078	-2.2%	-6.5%
Jan-25	3,345	-4.9%	1.7%	2,044	-1.6%	-6.4%
Feb-25	3,516	5.1%	15.8%	2,023	-1.0%	-8.1%
Mar-25	3,231	-8.1%	1.0%	2,046	1.1%	-9.7%
Apr-25	3,343	3.5%	-3.5%	2,064	0.9%	-10.2%
May-25	3,329	-0.4%	2.8%	2,072	0.4%	-9.8%
Jun-25	3,384	1.7%	5.4%	2,018	-2.6%	-9.7%
Jul-25	3,125	-7.7%	-4.7%	1,974	-2.2%	-9.3%
Aug-25	3,237	3.6%	-9.3%	1,913	-3.1%	-11.5%
Sep-25	3,085	-4.7%	-11.2%	1,874	-2.0%	-13.9%
Oct-25	3,210	4.1%	-7.2%	1,880	0.3%	-13.3%
Nov-25	3,083	-4.0%	-14.9%	1,868	-0.7%	-12.1%
Dec-25	3,178	3.1%	-9.7%	1,858	-0.5%	-10.6%
Jan-26	3,056	-3.8%	-8.6%	1,871	0.7%	-8.5%
Feb-26	3,212	5.1%	-8.6%	1,919	2.6%	-5.1%
Mar-26	3,083	-4.0%	-4.6%	1,954	1.8%	-4.5%
Apr-26	3,225	4.6%	-3.5%	2,038	4.3%	-1.2%
May-26	2,958	-8.3%	-11.1%	2,218	8.8%	7.0%

Source: China General Administration of Customs.

Historical Information

Net exports for the full year of 2025 were 1,742kt, or down (4%) y/y or by (67kt).

Net exports for full-year 2024 were 1,810kt, up 16% y/y or by 252kt compared with the same period in 2023. FY2023 net exports were 1,557kt, which was 21% higher y/y, or up 275kt. China's full-year 2022 TiO₂ net exports of 1,283kt were 163kt or 15% higher y/y. The global TiO₂ market normally increases at a ~3% rate, or ~200kt annually. We believe TiO₂ global demand growth in 2023 was likely flattish and that global demand contracted in 2022 at a mid-single-digit rate. Net export volumes from China grew 73.9kt in 2021, and we think global TiO₂ demand likely grew about 0.9m tons to ~7.3m tons in 2021, exceeding its normal rate. Titanium dioxide shipments from North American companies were sharply lower in 2022 and 2023. We think demand recovered to 2021 levels in 2024. We estimate that demand was about flat in 2025.

We estimate that Chinese TiO₂ exports to Europe totaled about 244kt or 13% of total exports in 2024. Exports to Europe averaged 28kt/mo in the March to June period of 2024 and 12.6kt in the July to December period of 2024. Please see Table 8 for monthly exports to Europe (EU-27). Exports to China's largest TiO₂ trading partners in 2025 were India 257kt (14%), EU 169kt (9%), Turkey (7%), Vietnam (6%), S.Korea (5%), and Indonesia (5%). YTD, the primary destination of Chinese imports has been India (20%), followed by the EU (11%). In 2024, the major destinations were India 308kt (16%), EU 244kt (13%), Brazil 137kt (7%), South Korea (5%), Turkey (5%), and Vietnam (5%) – see Table 5. By comparison, we estimate that exports to Europe totaled 261kt in 2023, accounting for 15% of exports. 2023 exports to China's largest trading partners were India 248kt (15%), Brazil 113kt (7%), Turkey 95kt (6%), South Korea 89kt (5%), and Russia 73kt (4%).

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